No 14. Tokei, November 11th 1874.

Your Excellency,

Mr. Okubo arrived in Teintsin on the 3rd instant. During the afternoon of the same day, he made a visit to Li Hung Chang which was duly returned in the evening, the interview in both instances being of the most cordial character; and early the next morning the whole mission left in the "Appin". I stated in my telegram of the 2nd instant that I would accompany the High Commissioner. But when I arrived at Chefoo, feeling that I could not go further without entailing great expense to the Government with no hope of gaining any corresponding benefits, I begged leave from Mr. Okubo to proceed

国立公文書館 アジア歴史資料センター
Japan Center for Asian Historical Records
https://www.jacar.go.jp

direct to Japan in the "Kiusiu," with another party of officers, one of whom, Mr. Takahara, was the bearer of despatches from the High Commissioner to His Excellency Mr. Saijo. This was granted, and we left Chefoo at two o'clock on the morning of the 6th inst, and arrived at the anchorage in Yedo Bay at one o'clock this morning, having made the trip in 4 days and 21½ hours.

The results of Mr. Okubo's mission, the diplomatic phase of which came to a close on the day the Convention of Peking was signed, that is, the 31st of October last, are greater than Your Excellency may have been able to realize from the necessarily scanty information conveyed in my telegram of the 2nd instant. Indeed, the very re-opening of these negociations was a triumph for Japan, who, in the yielding by the Chinese to the principle of set-tlement as previously laid down by Mr. Okubo, found a full satisfaction given to her honor and pride. For on



this occasion, H. B. M's Minister appeared less in the role of one who was anxious to bring the weight of a mighty influence to bear upon the decision of the High Commissioner, which position he had so unsuccessfully attempted to assume at the beginning of the negociations, than that of a mediator between two friendly Countries in making known to one of them (Japan) that the other (China) had at last determined to yield to her just demands. And in the Convention the signing of which was the natural result of the reopening of these negotiations, not a few Considerable advantages were gained. The right of Japan to proceed to Formosa, in conformity with the verbal understanding entered into between the Tsung li Yamên and Mr. Soyeshima last year, is fully

国立公文書館 アジア歴史資料センター
Japan Center for Asian Historical Records
https://www.jacar.go.jp

acknowledged by the paying to her of four hundred thousand taels as an equivalent for outlays made by her during her temporary occupation of a portion of aboriginal Formosa. And a renunciation of the former pretentions of China to Soo Chow is implied by the payment of a sum of one hundred thousand taels to the families of those who came to a premature end at the hands of the Boutans, and whom, for the first time, She calls Japanese subjects.

It will not escape Your Excellency's attention that the amount thus to be paid, according to the terms of the Convention, is exactly that which General Saigo had been given to understand might be offered by China as a price for the evacuation of his position in Formosa. It must also be noted that this amount,



although the fact is not mentioned in the Convention, will have to be paid by the provincial treasury of Foh Kyen, in accordance with a previous understanding between them and the Central Government. So long as this understanding had not been changed, it was impossible for Mr. Okubo to obtain better terms without submitting to delays which references from Peking to Foochow would have rendered necessary, and which he could not afford. And this makes it the more regrettable that I was prevented from fulfilling my mission to Foochow in August last.

But small as the amount to be paid may be, it seems to me

国立公文書館 アジア歴史資料センター
Japan Center for Asian Historical Records

that it ought to satisfy Japan when taken in connection both with the advantages resulting to her, as above stated, by the terms of the Convention, and with other benefits which she has derived from the Formosa scheme. For, if the accession of Formosa to His Imperial Majesty's Crown has not been consummated, still, the operations of both the army and navy, so far away from the Mother Country, during the past nine months, taught them to know exactly what they will be capable of in case of need; and the experience and efficiency thus gained by them may be the means of ensuring their success in a more important field, should they hereafter be ~~again~~ called upon to again leave their homes in furtherance



of the views of their august Sovereign, or for the purpose of maintaining the integrity of the Empire against foreign aggression or violence.

I have the honor to be
Your Excellency's
Most Obedient humble Servant

Chas. W. Le Gendre

To
His Excellency
Okuma Shigenobu,
Minister of Colonization,
&c. &c. &c.

国立公文書館 アジア歴史資料センター
Japan Center for Asian Historical Records
http://www.jacar.go.jp